

DIGITAL LITERACY PROJECT

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INTRODUCTION:

This project is submitted as the final assessment for the CSE0001 Digital Literacy Course.

Based on the provided scenario, I have assumed the role of a Student Digital Ambassador, tasked with creating a comprehensive portfolio to guide peers through the complexities of the modern digital landscape. The project is structured around five core modules, covering visual communication, professional networking, coding collaboration, email etiquette, and cybersecurity. This project, includes infographics, profile screenshots, and code challenge proofs, are hosted in a centralized GitHub repository. This report documents my methodology for each task, reflecting on the tools used and the practical digital skills I have acquired to help my academic community navigate online spaces safely and professionally.

Task 1: Creating a Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

I developed a one-page Infographic with the help of Canva covering 3 topics across, the definition of Digital Literacy, Email Etiquettes, and outlining safe internet practices.

I chose **Canva** because of its intuitive drag-and-drop interface and the availability of professional icons that helped make the data more digestible for students. The design process involved distilling complex definitions into actionable bullet points to ensure the "Ambassador" role was effective, Making sure that every point has it own visual effect and arranging them into visual boxes as points was rather challenging for me, as selecting something over the other on overlapping details really got in the way but the inbuilt “lock” feature in Canva which locks the element and prevents any further change to the element on accident.

Also made sure to make the information as eye catching as possible with the help of using elements and images to highlight the topics. This task taught me that digital literacy isn't just about knowing how to use a computer, but about communicating technical information clearly to a non-technical audience. The final infographic is stored in the task-1-presentation/ folder as an exported high-quality image.

Task 2: Build Your Student Digital Portfolio

In this task, I focused on building a professional digital footprint by establishing accounts on **GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle**. On GitHub, I initialized a profile README that serves as my digital "landing page," detailing my current branch and my goal of mastering Python and being excellent at software engineering. On LinkedIn, I updated my education section to reflect my enrolment at VIT Bhopal and set my expected graduation year to 2029. I specifically chose Kaggle as my third platform to begin tracking my journey in data science competitions and datasets. These platforms are essential tools that I will use over the next four years to showcase my projects to potential internship coordinators and employers. The most valuable lesson here was realizing how interconnected these platforms are; my GitHub code often informs my Kaggle work, which in turn strengthens my LinkedIn professional profile. Screenshots of all three finalized profiles have been added to the task-2-portfolio/ directory for assessment.

Task 3: Explore Coding & Collaboration Platforms

For the technical exploration, I made use of HackerRank, where I completed the "Introduction to Python" challenge. I successfully cleared the initial challenges, earning my first star. This, in turn, proved to be an excellent motivator. Moreover, I moved on to cloud collaboration by creating a "5 Question Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz" using Google Forms. This consists of multiple questions, both multiple-choice and short answer, meant to gauge the student's level of understanding about phishing and internet privacy. I have included the live form link in the repository's README, along with screenshots of the form and the linked Google Sheet, located within the task-3-platforms folder. These tools hold great academic significance, as they allow me to fill the gap between coding logic and data management. HackerRank helps me measure my coding standards globally, while Google Workspace helps me collaborate on group projects or peer-to-peer teaching. These softwares are just few examples of the many that are out there and can be used to the benefit of the students many more just like me.

Task 4: Draft a Professional Email & Etiquette Guide

As a Digital Ambassador, I demonstrated professional communication by crafting two specific emails: one for requesting an assignment extension and another for inquiring about an internship. These drafts aimed to demonstrate a respectful tone, subject line, and professional closing. Additionally, I prepared a "Social Media Do's and Don'ts" checklist to assist my peers in avoiding common digital blunders, like over-sharing sensitive personal details. For example, one real-life scenario is when a student lost a job opportunity because of unprofessional comments shared in a public forum several years ago. This experience taught me the permanence of our digital footprint. I realized digital communication is not just about the words we choose to convey; it is about the professional image we project over time. All drafts and checklists are included in the task-4-email-etiquette/ folder.

Task 5: Cybercrime Awareness Case Study & Prevention Guide

During my research on cybercrime for this module, I decided to specifically look at Ransomware, a subject that is extremely relevant to students and organizations in general. However, it was the manner in which cyber attackers utilize 'urgency' to prompt their targets to click on suspicious links or compromise security settings in times of crisis that surprised me the most. This research experience also taught me that while technical security is half the battle in cybercrime prevention, it is also the psychological element that is often the weakest link in security systems. As a result, I will personally make sure that I no longer rely on single-factor authentication and will also make sure that all my critical academic data is stored in an offline backup regularly. My new list of preventive measures includes the link to the National Cyber Crime Portal and the 1930 helpline number for immediate reporting. The full case study and 8-point prevention guide can be found in the task-5-cybercrime/ folder.

Conclusion

This Digital Literacy project was a highly constructive experience that bridged the gap between basic internet usage and professional digital management. By assuming the role of a Student Digital Ambassador, I was able to gain a much deeper understanding of how to curate a professional profile on platforms like GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle. This project posed a challenge on how to present myself professionally and share detailed information in the forms of presentations and graphs, how to communicate through emails. By documenting my progress in terms of technical progress—clearing coding challenges and researching and understanding complex cybersecurity threats—I was able to gain a much deeper sense of how to effectively communicate this information to my peers. This portfolio is a strong foundation on which I will continue to build throughout my four-year B.Tech degree.